



Big data

Business is trying to harness the huge amount of consumer data now available online. This information can be analyzed and used to create detailed profiles to target customers more precisely.

How it works

Big data is the huge amount of digital information transmitted via the internet every day. It is streamed at high speed and in many different formats, from database statistics to video, audio, and email

documents. The challenge for most organizations is to sift through big data to find information that has the potential to add value to their business. Software tools are now available that can analyze the masses of external data generated on the internet.

Internally and externally mined big data

Businesses are now able to access data from sources such as mobile communications, social media networks, and commercial transactions, which show the activity of billions of people.

External data source

An ever-expanding amount of data is being generated by outside organizations, which will prove increasingly valuable to businesses.



Social media

Data monitors what people are saying about the organization and its products.



Audio

Data includes news broadcasts, interviews, call center recordings, and podcasts.



Photos and video

Data comprises blogs, images, video recordings from entertainment media, and surveillance.



Public data

Information shared outside the company, such as press releases, job descriptions, and marketing materials.

Big data store

Big data

The volume of data is potentially so vast it cannot easily be moved and may overwhelm most organizations.

Big data vendor

Provides services, systems, and tools enabling companies to store, access, and analyze data. Vendor offers applications to suit individual business needs.